



GRADE 11- ENGLISH OLYMPIAD

SECTION 1 – WORD AND STRUCTURE KNOWLEDGE

Q1. Choose the word that is closest in meaning to “equivocal”.

- A. Certain
- B. Ambiguous
- C. Transparent
- D. Unavoidable

Q2. Choose the word opposite in meaning to “profligate”.

- A. Wasteful
- B. Extravagant
- C. Economical
- D. Reckless

Q3. Select the correctly spelt word.

- A. Consciencious
- B. Conscientous
- C. Conscientious
- D. Conscienciousness

Q4. Choose the correct one-word substitution:

“A person who deliberately sets fire to property”

- A. Arsonist
- B. Vandal
- C. Extortionist
- D. Saboteur

Q5. Choose the correct analogy:

OBSTINATE : PERSUASION :: ?

- A. Hungry : Food
- B. Fragile : Care



C. Generous : Charity

D. Ignorant : Education

Q6. Identify the sentence in which the underlined word is used correctly.

A. The principal complemented the new building.

B. She complimented him on his remarkable performance.

C. The two colours compliment each other perfectly.

D. He received a complement for his excellent speech.

Q7. Choose the correct option:

Neither the principal nor the teachers _____ willing to postpone the examination.

A. was

B. is

C. were

D. has been

Q8. Select the correct form:

By the time the rescue team arrived, the villagers _____ the injured climber to safety.

A. carried

B. have carried

C. had carried

D. were carrying

Q9. Choose the correct sentence.

A. No sooner had the bell rung when the students rushed out.

B. No sooner did the bell ring than the students rushed out.

C. No sooner the bell rang than the students rushed out.

D. No sooner had the bell rang than the students rushed out.

Q10. Choose the correct modal:

You _____ have informed us earlier; the entire arrangement could have been avoided.

A. should

B. would

C. must

D. might



11. Choose the correct option:

I would rather you _____ the matter with the committee before making a decision.

- A. discuss
- B. discussed
- C. will discuss
- D. have discussed

Q12. Identify the error:

Each of the proposals / have been carefully examined / before the final decision / was announced.

- A. Each of the proposals
- B. have been carefully examined
- C. before the final decision
- D. was announced

Q13. Choose the correct passive form:

People believe that the scientist discovered the substance accidentally.

- A. The scientist is believed to have discovered the substance accidentally.
- B. The scientist was believed to discover the substance accidentally.
- C. The scientist has believed to discover the substance accidentally.
- D. The scientist is believed that he discovered the substance accidentally.

Q14. Choose the correct indirect speech:

The teacher said, "Why have you not submitted your assignment?"

- A. The teacher asked why I had not submitted my assignment.
- B. The teacher asked why had I not submitted my assignment.
- C. The teacher said why I did not submit my assignment.
- D. The teacher asked why I have not submitted my assignment.

Q15. Choose the correctly punctuated sentence.

- A. My brother, who lives in Delhi is visiting us tomorrow.
- B. My brother who lives in Delhi, is visiting us tomorrow.
- C. My brother, who lives in Delhi, is visiting us tomorrow.
- D. My brother who lives in Delhi is, visiting us tomorrow.



Q16. Choose the appropriate phrasal verb:

The committee decided to _____ the proposal until further evidence was available.

- A. put off
- B. put up
- C. put out
- D. put through

Q17. The expression "to throw down the gauntlet" means:

- A. To surrender
- B. To issue a challenge
- C. To apologise publicly
- D. To avoid confrontation

Q18. Choose the correct preposition:

The new policy is not consistent _____ the principles stated in the constitution.

- A. to
- B. with
- C. by
- D. for

Q19. Choose the correct conjunction:

_____ he had very little experience, he handled the negotiation remarkably well.

- A. Because
- B. Although
- C. Unless
- D. Since

Q20. Choose the grammatically correct sentence.

- A. The criteria for selection is clearly stated.
- B. The criterion for selection are clearly stated.
- C. The criteria for selection are clearly stated.
- D. The criterions for selection are clearly stated.

Q21. Choose the word that best completes the sentence:



Her explanation was so _____ that even the most complicated aspect of the theory became understandable.

- A. lucid
- B. obscure
- C. cryptic
- D. evasive

Q22. Choose the correct meaning of "laconic".

- A. Using more words than necessary
- B. Expressing much in very few words
- C. Speaking in an emotional manner
- D. Refusing to communicate

23. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. Hardly had we reached the station when the train left.
- B. Hardly we had reached the station when the train left.
- C. Hardly had we reached the station than the train left.
- D. Hardly did we reached the station when the train left.

Q24. Complete the sentence:

If the authorities _____ the warning earlier, the damage might have been considerably less.

- A. heed
- B. had heeded
- C. have heeded
- D. would heed

Q25. Choose the word that does NOT belong to the group.

- A. Candid
- B. Frank
- C. Forthright
- D. Devious

26. Select the correct order of the words to form a meaningful sentence:

- P. rarely
- Q. such dedication



R. have I witnessed

S. among young researchers

A. P-Q-R-S

B. R-P-Q-S

C. P-R-Q-S

D. R-Q-P-S

Q27. Choose the best replacement for the underlined part:

Despite of being exhausted, she continued working.

A. Despite being exhausted

B. Despite she was exhausted

C. In spite exhausted

D. Although of being exhausted

28. Choose the correctly formed sentence.

A. The report needs to be thoroughly revising.

B. The report needs thoroughly revised.

C. The report needs to be thoroughly revised.

D. The report needs being thoroughly revised.

Q29. Choose the word that best completes the sentence:

His argument was persuasive, but it lacked sufficient _____ to support the conclusion.

A. evidence

B. evidential

C. evidently

D. evidences

30. Choose the sentence with the most appropriate formal usage.

A. The manager wants to know what's up with the delay.

B. The manager wishes to ascertain the reason for the delay.

C. The manager wants to figure out the delay thing.

D. The manager is asking what's going on about the delay.

SECTION 2 – READING

Questions 31–40 | 1 mark each



Read the passage carefully.

The Value of Being Uncertain

Modern education often rewards students for producing correct answers quickly. Yet some of the most valuable intellectual discoveries begin with a person admitting that they do not know something.

Uncertainty can initially feel uncomfortable. A student who is unsure of an answer may assume that uncertainty indicates weakness. In reality, recognising the limits of one's knowledge can be the beginning of deeper learning. It encourages a person to ask better questions, investigate evidence and reconsider assumptions.

Scientists regularly work with uncertainty. A scientific hypothesis is not treated as an unquestionable truth; it is tested against evidence and revised when necessary. This willingness to change one's understanding is not a failure of science but one of its greatest strengths.

The same principle applies beyond laboratories. In everyday life, people often make decisions based on incomplete information. Someone who confidently assumes that they understand another person's motives may overlook important facts. By contrast, a person who remains open to alternative explanations is more likely to examine the situation fairly.

This does not mean that people should avoid making decisions until complete certainty is possible. Such certainty is rarely available. Instead, intellectual maturity involves knowing when evidence is strong enough to justify a conclusion and when further investigation is necessary.

Perhaps, therefore, education should not merely teach students how to find answers. It should also teach them how to recognise worthwhile questions, evaluate evidence and remain comfortable with uncertainty while searching for better explanations.

Q31. What is the central argument of the passage?

- A. Students should avoid answering difficult questions.
- B. Scientific methods are more reliable than everyday reasoning.
- C. Recognising uncertainty can contribute to deeper and more responsible thinking.
- D. Education should focus exclusively on scientific research.

Q32. According to the passage, uncertainty can encourage people to:

- A. abandon difficult problems
- B. ask better questions and examine evidence



- C. reject scientific explanations
- D. delay every decision indefinitely

33. Why does the writer describe uncertainty in science?

- A. To show that scientists frequently make mistakes
- B. To prove that scientific knowledge is unreliable
- C. To illustrate how knowledge can be revised in response to evidence
- D. To suggest that students should become scientists

34. The phrase "limits of one's knowledge" most nearly means:

- A. the boundaries of what one currently understands
- B. the restrictions imposed by teachers
- C. the inability to learn new subjects
- D. the number of books one has read

Q35. Which of the following can be inferred about people who assume they understand others' motives?

- A. They are always correct.
- B. They may overlook relevant information.
- C. They make decisions more quickly.
- D. They are more scientifically minded.

Q36. The author's attitude towards uncertainty is best described as:

- A. dismissive
- B. fearful
- C. cautiously positive
- D. completely indifferent

Q37. According to the passage, intellectual maturity involves:

- A. refusing to change one's opinion
- B. waiting for absolute certainty
- C. judging when evidence is sufficient for a conclusion
- D. accepting every possible explanation

Q38. Which statement would the author most likely agree with?



- A. A quick answer is always better than an uncertain one.
- B. Uncertainty should prevent people from making decisions.
- C. Good reasoning requires both evidence and awareness of its limitations.
- D. Scientific thinking has little relevance outside laboratories.

Q39. The final paragraph suggests that education should teach students to:

- A. memorise more information
- B. find answers without questioning them
- C. distinguish between worthwhile questions and unsupported assumptions
- D. avoid making conclusions

Q40. Which title best suits the passage?

- A. The Problem with Modern Science
- B. Why We Should Never Be Certain
- C. Learning to Think Through Uncertainty
- D. The Failure of Traditional Education

SECTION 3 – SPOKEN AND WRITTEN EXPRESSION

Questions 41–45 | 1 mark each

Q41. Your classmate has delivered an excellent presentation. Which response is most appropriate?

- A. "That wasn't bad, I suppose."
- B. "You did exceptionally well. Your explanation was very clear."
- C. "I could have done it better."
- D. "Everyone already knew that."

Q42. You disagree with your teacher's suggestion but want to remain respectful. Choose the best response.

- A. "You're completely wrong."
- B. "That makes no sense whatsoever."
- C. "I see your point, but I wonder whether we could also consider another approach."
- D. "I don't agree, and that's final."



Q43. You need some information from a university office. Which is the most appropriate formal request?

- A. "Hey, can you send me the details?"
- B. "I want the details immediately."
- C. "Could you please provide me with the relevant information regarding the application process?"
- D. "Send the application stuff as soon as possible."

Q44. Your friend says, "I'm afraid I didn't get selected for the team." What is the most empathetic response?

- A. "That's your problem."
- B. "You should have tried harder."
- C. "I'm sorry to hear that. I know you were hoping to be selected."
- D. "At least someone else got selected."

Q45. Choose the most suitable response:

"Would you mind explaining how this system works?"

- A. "Not at all. I'd be happy to explain it."
- B. "Yes, I would mind."
- C. "You should know that already."
- D. "Why should I explain it?"

SECTION 4 – ACHIEVERS SECTION

Questions 46–50 | 3 marks each

Q46. Choose the option that contains no grammatical error.

- A. Had I known about the changes earlier, I would have informed everyone who was concerned.
- B. Had I knew about the changes earlier, I would have informed everyone who was concerned.
- C. If I would have known about the changes earlier, I had informed everyone concerned.
- D. Had I known about the changes earlier, I would informed everyone who was concerned.

Q47. Arrange the following sentences to form a coherent paragraph.

- P. Consequently, the ability to evaluate information has become increasingly important.
- Q. The internet has made an enormous amount of information available to almost everyone.



- R. However, accessibility does not necessarily guarantee accuracy.
S. Readers must therefore learn to distinguish reliable evidence from unsupported claims.

- A. Q-R-P-S
B. Q-P-R-S
C. R-Q-P-S
D. P-Q-R-S

Read the extract and answer Question 48.

A city introduced a programme encouraging residents to replace short car journeys with walking or cycling. Six months later, officials reported that traffic levels had fallen only slightly. However, surveys showed that participants reported improved fitness, reduced stress and greater awareness of how often they used cars unnecessarily.

Q48. Which conclusion is best supported by the extract?

- A. The programme was unsuccessful because traffic did not fall dramatically.
B. The programme had benefits that could not be measured solely through traffic reduction.
C. Residents completely stopped using cars for short journeys.
D. The programme was designed primarily to reduce stress rather than traffic.

Q49. Choose the sentence in which the word “only” is positioned most appropriately to convey the intended meaning:

Intended meaning: The speaker contacted no one except Maya.

- A. Only I contacted Maya.
B. I only contacted Maya.
C. I contacted only Maya.
D. I contacted Maya only yesterday.

50. A school wants to encourage students to participate in a debate competition. Which statement would be most persuasive?

- A. “The debate competition will happen next Friday.”
B. “Students who participate will receive certificates.”
C. “Debating gives you an opportunity to test your ideas, respond thoughtfully to opposing views and develop confidence in expressing complex arguments.”
D. “Many students have already registered for the competition.”



ANSWER KEY

Section 1

1. B
2. C
3. C
4. A
5. B



6. B
7. C
8. C
9. B
10. A
11. B
12. B
13. A
14. A
15. C
16. A
17. B
18. B
19. B
20. C
21. A
22. B
23. A
24. B
25. D
26. C
27. A
28. C
29. A



30. B

31. C

32. B

33. C

34. A

35. B

36. C

37. C

38. C

39. C

40. C

41. B

42. C

43. C

44. C

45. A

46. A

47. A

48. B

49. C

50. C